005-01 DEFENDING (v.) THE INDEFENSIBLE 为不可辩护之事 辩护

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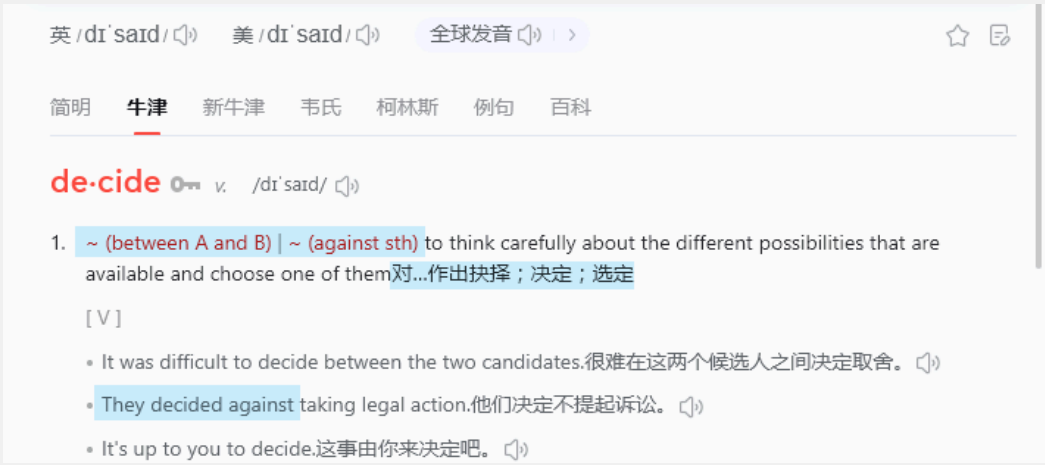
While some British military officials had doubted that /the Japanese were capable of challenging (v.) the mighty 强大的；巨大的 British Empire, more farsighted 有远见的；深谋远虑的 leaders **realized** (v.) *as soon as full-scale 全面的 war **broke out** with Germany in 1940* **that** /hong Kong could not be defended (v.).

But they also stressed (v.) the need **to hold on to** 紧紧抓住或保持某物,不放手或不失去它;坚守；保留 the colony **to maintain face** 保全面子 and to prevent the harbor from falling into enemy hands.

Prime Minister 首相，总理 Winston Churchill **decided (v.) against** *reducing the local garrison* 驻军；守卫部队, which would weaken (v.) both the prestige 声望；威望 of the empire and the morale 士气；精神面貌 in China.
Yet the Hong Kong government was in a weak position to prepare for an invasion.

Example 1. 案例
decide against sth.



The huge number of refugees from China 谓 drained (v.)耗尽；消耗 resources (by early 1941, the colony’ s population was well (adv.)大大地，远远地 over 1.5 million), while 主

the colony’s status as *a free port*, coupled with 加上；连同 its *open border* with China, 谓 made controlling (v.)immigration —not to mention 更不用说 the movement of Japanese agents 特工；间谍 and sympathizers 同情者；支持者 —impossible.

Example 2. 案例

While some British military officials had doubted that the Japanese were capable of challenging the mighty British Empire, more farsighted leaders realized as soon as full-scale war broke out with Germany in 1940 that Hong Kong could not be defended.
But they also stressed the need to hold on to the colony to maintain face and to prevent the harbor from falling into enemy hands.
Prime Minister Winston Churchill decided against reducing the local garrison, which would weaken both the prestige of the empire and the morale in China.
Yet the Hong Kong government was in a weak position to prepare for an invasion.
The huge number of refugees from China drained resources (by early 1941, the colony’s population was well over 1.5 million), while the colony’s status as a free port, coupled with its open border with China, made controlling immigration—not to mention the movement of Japanese agents and sympathizers—impossible.

尽管一些英国军方官员曾怀疑日本人是否有能力挑战强大的大英帝国，但更具远见的领导人在1940年与德国全面开战后立即意识到，香港已无力守住。然而，他们也强调必须坚守这片殖民地，以维护英国的颜面，并防止港口落入敌手。首相温斯顿·丘吉尔决定不削减驻港部队，因为这会削弱帝国的威望和打击中国的士气。然而，香港政府在应对入侵方面却处于弱势地位。大量来自中国的难民涌入耗尽了资源（到1941年初，香港人口已超过150万），而香港作为自由港的地位，加上与中国接壤的开放边界，使得控制移民——更不用说控制日本特工和同情者的流动——变得不可能。

The colonial government was thus *in the unenviable (a.)不值得羡慕的，不值得嫉妒的 position* of preparing (v.) **to defend (v.) a colony** that could not be defended, even while **maintaining (v.) its neutrality** 中立；中立立场.

因此，殖民政府陷入了一种尴尬境地：它准备保卫一个根本无法保卫的殖民地，即便它同时还在保持中立。

In September 1938 /the government reinstated (v.)恢复；使复原；使复职 the Emergency Powers Ordinance 法令；条例；训令 of 1922, which allowed the police to deport 驱逐；驱逐出境 anyone not employed; prohibit 禁止；阻止 public meetings and organizations; censor (v.)审查；检查 Chinese newspapers, pamphlets 小册子；活页文选, and placards 标语牌；招贴；海报; and call up 征召；召集 a special force of constables 警察；警员.

Example 3. 案例
constable

(n.) (in Britain, Australia, Canada, New Zealand, etc) a police officer of the lowest rank

→ 来自拉丁短语comes stabuli, 管马的官员。comes, 词源同 count(（按顺序）数数；计数), 伯爵，stable,马厩。后来词义发生了变化。比较marshal, 将军，原指管马的官员。

英 / ˈkʌnstəbl /　美 / ˈkɑːnstəbl /　全球发音

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con·stable *n.* /ˈkʌnstəbl/

(used especially when talking to a police officer of the lowest rank与最低级别的警察谈话时用)

= police constable

• Have you finished your report, Constable?警察，你的报告完成了吗？

——see also chief constable

They also allowed the government to control food prices, intern (v.) (由于政治原因或战时) 拘留；禁闭 Chinese and Japanese soldiers taking refuge 避难；庇护 in Hong Kong, and prohibit (v.) repairing and provisioning 供给…食物及必需品；为…提供补给 Japanese or Chinese vessels 船只；舰船；容器 involved in the hostilities 战争;敌对行动；敌意.

Example 4. 案例

The colonial government was thus in the unenviable position of preparing to defend a colony that could not be defended, even while maintaining its neutrality.
In September 1938 the government reinstated the Emergency Powers Ordinance of 1922, which allowed the police to deport anyone not employed; prohibit public meetings and organizations; censor Chinese newspapers, pamphlets, and placards; and call up a special force of constables.
They also allowed the government to control food prices, intern Chinese and Japanese soldiers taking refuge in Hong Kong, and prohibit repairing and provisioning Japanese or Chinese vessels involved in the hostilities.

因此，殖民政府陷入了进退两难的境地：一方面要准备保卫一个根本无法保卫的殖民地，另一方面又要维持中立。1938年9月，政府恢复了1922年的《紧急权力条例》，该条例授权警方驱逐所有无业人员；禁止公共集会和组织；审查中文报纸、小册子和标语；并征召一支特别警队。此外，该条例还允许政府控制食品价格，拘禁在香港避难的中国和日本士兵，并禁止维修和补给参与战争的日本或中国船只。

Even as the government was professing 宣称；声称；公开表明 Hong Kong’s neutrality, it was preparing to defend (v.) the colony against a Japanese invasion.

In July 1939, 主 all British male subjects （尤指君主制国家的）国民，臣民 of *European origin* 血统 between the ages of eighteen and fifty-five 谓 were made liable (a.)有法律责任的；有义务的 for *compulsory (a.)强制的；义务的；必须做的 service* in the Defence Reserve 替补队员，后备队员.

1939年7月，所有年龄在18岁至55岁之间、欧洲血统的英国男性公民, 都有义务在国防预备役中服兵役。

After criticism 批评，批判 from the local press and Chinese unofficial members of the Legislative Council, in summer 1940 /the government began a program of air-raid (a.)空袭的 tunnels 防空隧道.

In 1940, the colonial government evacuated (v.)疏散；撤离 a number of British women and children to Australia.

Among the evacuees 被疏散者；撤离者 were Eurasians 后定说明 holding British passports, 主 who because of the Australian government’s *White Australia policy* 谓 **were dropped off** in Manila.

This provoked 激起；引发；招致 an outcry (n.)强烈抗议；公开反对 from Eurasian and Chinese leaders in Hong Kong.

In July 1941, Japanese assets 资产，财产 in Hong Kong were frozen 冻结（资产）；使（资金）无法流通 (as they were in Britain and the United States), although *barter 以物易物；物物交换 trading* continued for a while.

Example 5. 案例

Even as the government was professing Hong Kong’s neutrality, it was preparing to defend the colony against a Japanese invasion.
In July 1939, all British male subjects of European origin between the ages of eighteen and fifty-five were made liable for compulsory service in the Defence Reserve.
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In 1940, the colonial government evacuated a number of British women and children to Australia.
Among the evacuees were Eurasians holding British passports, who because of the Australian government’s White Australia policy were dropped off in Manila.
This provoked an outcry from Eurasian and Chinese leaders in Hong Kong.

In July 1941, Japanese assets in Hong Kong were frozen (as they were in Britain and the United States), although barter trading continued for a while.

尽管政府宣称香港保持中立，但实际上却在为抵御日本入侵做准备。1939年7月，所有年龄在18至55岁之间的欧洲裔英国男性公民都被强制征召入伍，加入国防预备役。在遭到本地媒体和立法会华人非官方议员的批评后，政府于1940年夏季开始修建防空隧道。同年，殖民地政府将一些英国妇女儿童撤离到澳大利亚。撤离者中包括一些持有英国护照的欧亚裔人士，由于澳大利亚政府的“白澳政策”，他们被直接送往马尼拉。这引起了香港欧亚裔和华裔领袖的强烈抗议。1941年7月，日本在香港的资产被冻结（如同在英国和美国一样），但易货贸易在一段时间内仍在继续。

Like all British colonies, Hong Kong became part of the British war effort /once Britain declared war on Germany for invading Poland in September 1939.

Hong Kong had already been part of the Chinese war effort, its formally 形式上，理论上 *neutral 中立的 status* notwithstanding 尽管；虽然, but 主 the fact that both China and Britain were now at war 谓 joined (v.) the Chinese and the British communities in common cause 共同目标；共同事业.

尽管香港在形式上保持中立，但它早已是中国抗战的一部分。而如今中国和英国都卷入了战争，这一事实使华人社群和英国社群为了共同的目标联合了起来。

In April 1940 /the colony contributed to the British war effort through new taxes and several gifts 恩赐，授予 of cash.

1940年4月，该殖民地通过新税收和几笔现金捐赠，为英国的战争努力做出了贡献。

The South China *Morning Post* 南华早报 organized *a Bomber Fund* 轰炸机基金, while both Chinese and expatriates 侨民；移居国外的人 **contributed to campaigns** such as the British *Prisoners of War* Fund 英国战俘基金, the British War Organization Fund, the Chinese Relief Association 救济协会, and the Hong Kong and South China Branch of *the British Fund* for *the Relief of Distress* 苦难；困境；贫困 in China.

《南华早报》组织了轰炸机基金，而中国人和外籍人士都为诸如英国战俘基金、英国战争组织基金、中国救济协会, 以及英国援华赈灾基金香港及华南分会等活动捐款。

Under *the Chinese Defence League*’s “Bowl of Rice” 一碗米饭 campaign, donors 捐赠者 **ordered (v.)订购；点餐 meals** at *participating (a.)restaurants* /but ate (v.) only a bowl of *steamed (a.)蒸熟的，蒸的 rice*, **donating** (v.) the price of the meal **to** the Chinese war effort.

在中国保卫同盟的“一碗饭”运动中，捐赠者在"参与活动的餐馆"点餐，但只吃一碗白米饭，将这顿饭的费用捐给中国的抗战事业。

Robert Ho Tung, the Eurasian tycoon 大亨；巨头；实业家, donated (v.) a vessel 船舰；船只；容器 to the Hong Kong *Naval Volunteer 志愿者 Force* 海军志愿军.

Example 6. 案例

Like all British colonies, Hong Kong became part of the British war effort once Britain declared war on Germany for invading Poland in September 1939.
Hong Kong had already been part of the Chinese war effort, its formally neutral status notwithstanding, but the fact that both China and Britain were now at war joined the Chinese and the British communities in common cause.
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several gifts of cash.
The South China Morning Post organized a Bomber Fund, while both Chinese and expatriates contributed to campaigns such as the British Prisoners of War Fund, the British War Organization Fund, the Chinese Relief Association, and the Hong Kong and South China Branch of the British Fund for the Relief of Distress in China.
Under the Chinese Defence League’s “Bowl of Rice” campaign, donors ordered meals at participating restaurants but ate only a bowl of steamed rice, donating the price of the meal to the Chinese war effort.
Robert Ho Tung, the Eurasian tycoon, donated a vessel to the Hong Kong Naval Volunteer Force.

与所有英国殖民地一样，1939 年 9 月英国因德国入侵波兰而对德宣战后，香港也加入了英国的战争行动。尽管香港名义上保持中立，但此前它已参与了中国的战争行动。然而，中英两国同时参战的事实，使得香港的华人社群和英国侨民团结在了同一阵线。1940 年 4 月，香港通过增税和捐款等方式为英国的战争行动做出了贡献。《南华早报》组织了轰炸机基金，华人及侨民也纷纷捐款，支持英国战俘基金、英国战争组织基金、华人救济会以及英国救济中国灾民基金会香港及华南分会等机构。在中华民国防卫同盟发起的“一碗饭”活动中，捐款者在参与活动的餐厅点餐，但只吃一碗米饭，并将餐费捐给中国抗战。欧亚混血富豪何东向香港海军志愿部队捐赠了一艘船。

Despite the Chinese community’s generous (a.)慷慨的；大方的 contributions to both war efforts, the colonial government doubted that /it could **rely on** the Chinese to help defend (v.) the colony.

The official view was that /because most Chinese considered Hong Kong a temporary home, they were incapable 不能的；无能力的 of making any sacrifice for Hong Kong.

Yet the government had done little *over the previous century* to evince (v.)表明；显示 the type of loyalty 忠诚；忠心 that it now sought (v.)寻求；追求 from its Chinese subjects. Nor had the government shown that /it trusted the Chinese enough to enlist (v.)征募；招募 them to defend the colony.

然而，在过去的一个世纪里，政府几乎没有采取什么行动来展现如今它向其华人臣民所寻求的那种忠诚。

Only in May 1938 was a Chinese company added to *the Volunteer Defence Corps* 志愿防卫队, founded in 1855 before the Second Opium War.

And only after 主 the Chinese members of the Legislative Council 谓 **had assured** the governor **of** Chinese support /倒装 **were** *British subjects of Chinese extraction* 血统；出身 **allowed** to register for the Defence Reserve.

并且，只有在立法局的华人议员, 向总督保证华人会提供支持之后，具有华人血统的英国臣民, 才被允许登记加入防务预备队。

Example 7. 案例
And only after ... were *British subjects of Chinese extraction* allowed

...

only + 状语置于句首 → 主句部分要倒装: 助动词 /be 动词 / 情态动词 提到主语前面。

例:
- Only then /did I realize the truth. 只有到那时我才明白真相。
- Only in this way /can you solve the problem. 只有用这种方法你才能解决问题。
- Only after he apologized /did she forgive him. 只有在他道歉之后，她才原谅了他。

assure sb. of sth. 向某人保证某事

本句: had assured the governor of Chinese support 向总督保证华人的支持

又例:
- I assure you of my honesty. 我向你保证我的诚实。
- They assured us of their help. 他们向我们保证会提供帮助。

Although the British War Office 英国陆军部 finally agreed to accept Chinese infantry 步兵 forces in October 1941, the minimum 最小的；最低的 height and weight restrictions 限制；约束 **kept** many of them **out**: of (引出总数量) the six hundred 后定说明 who applied, only thirty-five were accepted.

Example 8. 案例
我问: 这里 of the six hundred 中的 of 是什么意思?

这里的 **of用于引出总数，强调“六百人”这个整体范围。** 表示 “在……之中” 或 “从……中” ，

如:
- Of the 100 students, 80 passed the exam.（在100名学生中，有80人通过了考试。）
- Of all the options, this is the best.（在所有选项中，这是最好的。）

为什么用 “of” 而不是 “from” ？
虽然 “from” 也有“来自”的意思，但在这个语境下：

- Of 强调 “包含关系”（六百人是一个集合，录取的三十五人包含在其中）。
- From 通常强调 “来源或起点”（如：He came from China. 他来自中国）。

Example 9. 案例

Despite the Chinese community’s generous contributions to both war efforts, the colonial government doubted that it could rely on the Chinese to help defend the colony.
The official view was that because most Chinese considered Hong Kong a temporary home, they were incapable of making any sacrifice for Hong Kong.
Yet the government had done little over the previous century to evince the type of loyalty that it now sought from its Chinese subjects.
Nor had the government shown that it trusted the Chinese enough to enlist them to defend the colony.
Only in May 1938 was a Chinese company added to the Volunteer Defence Corps, founded in 1855 before the Second Opium War.
And only after the Chinese members of the Legislative Council had assured the governor of Chinese support were British subjects of Chinese extraction allowed to register for the Defence Reserve.
Although the British War Office finally agreed to accept Chinese infantry forces in October 1941, the minimum height and weight restrictions kept many of them out: of the six hundred who applied, only thirty-five were accepted.

尽管华人社群对两次战争都做出了慷慨的贡献，但殖民政府仍然怀疑能否依靠华人保卫殖民地。官方观点认为，由于大多数华人将香港视为暂时的居所，他们无法为香港做出任何牺牲。然而，在过去一个世纪里，政府几乎没有展现出如今所寻求的那种华人忠诚。政府也从未表现出对华人的足够信任，以至于可以征召他们保卫殖民地。直到1938年5月，一支华人连队才被纳入成立于1855年、第二次鸦片战争之前的志愿防卫队。而且，只有在立法会华人议员向总督保证华人的支持后，拥有华人血统的英国公民才被允许登记加入国防预备队。尽管英国陆军部最终在1941年10月同意接收华人步兵部队，但最低身高和体重限制将许多人拒之门外：在600名申请者中，只有35人被录取。